

expr(1) — Linux manual page

[NAME](#) | [SYNOPSIS](#) | [DESCRIPTION](#) | [AUTHOR](#) | [REPORTING BUGS](#) | [COPYRIGHT](#) | [SEE ALSO](#) | [COLOPHON](#)

 EXPR(1)

User Commands

EXPR(1)

NAME [top](#)

expr – evaluate expressions

SYNOPSIS [top](#)

expr *EXPRESSION*
expr *OPTION*

DESCRIPTION [top](#)

--help display this help and exit

--version
output version information and exit

Print the value of *EXPRESSION* to standard output. A blank line below separates increasing precedence groups. *EXPRESSION* may be:

ARG1 | *ARG2*
ARG1 if it is neither null nor 0, otherwise *ARG2*

ARG1 & *ARG2*
ARG1 if neither argument is null or 0, otherwise 0

ARG1 < *ARG2*
ARG1 is less than *ARG2*

ARG1 <= *ARG2*
ARG1 is less than or equal to *ARG2*

ARG1 = *ARG2*
ARG1 is equal to *ARG2*

ARG1 != *ARG2*
ARG1 is unequal to *ARG2*

ARG1 >= *ARG2*
ARG1 is greater than or equal to *ARG2*

ARG1 > ARG2
ARG1 is greater than ARG2

ARG1 + ARG2
arithmetic sum of ARG1 and ARG2

ARG1 - ARG2
arithmetic difference of ARG1 and ARG2

ARG1 * ARG2
arithmetic product of ARG1 and ARG2

ARG1 / ARG2
arithmetic quotient of ARG1 divided by ARG2

ARG1 % ARG2
arithmetic remainder of ARG1 divided by ARG2

STRING : REGEXP
anchored pattern match of REGEXP in STRING

match STRING REGEXP
same as STRING : REGEXP

substr STRING POS LENGTH
substring of STRING, POS counted from 1

index STRING CHARS
index in STRING where any CHARS is found, or 0

length STRING
length of STRING

+ TOKEN
interpret TOKEN as a string, even if it is a keyword like
'match' or an operator like '/'

(EXPRESSION)
value of EXPRESSION

Beware that many operators need to be escaped or quoted for shells. Comparisons are arithmetic if both ARGs are numbers, else lexicographical. Pattern matches return the string matched between W(and W) or null; if W(and W) are not used, they return the number of characters matched or 0.

Exit status is 0 if EXPRESSION is neither null nor 0, 1 if EXPRESSION is null or 0, 2 if EXPRESSION is syntactically invalid, and 3 if an error occurred.

AUTHOR [top](#)

Written by Mike Parker, James Youngman, and Paul Eggert.

REPORTING BUGS [top](#)

Report bugs to: bug-coreutils@gnu.org
GNU coreutils home page: <<https://www.gnu.org/software/coreutils/>>
General help using GNU software: <<https://www.gnu.org/gethelp/>>
Report any translation bugs to
<<https://translationproject.org/team/>>

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SEE ALSO [top](#)

Full documentation <<https://www.gnu.org/software/coreutils/expr>>
or available locally via: info '(coreutils) expr invocation'

COLOPHON [top](#)

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GNU coreutils 9.11

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EXPR(1)

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